Letter of Agreement
Between
Helsinki FIR and Sweden FIR

Last updated 26.01.2026

VATSIM
SCANDINAVIA

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1. General

1.1. Purpose

The purpose of this Letter of Agreement (LoA) is to define the coordination procedures to be applied between Helsinki FIR and Sweden FIR when providing ATS on the VATSIM network. The participating FIRs shall keep each other advised of any changes in the operational status of their facilities and navigational aids which may affect the procedures specified in this Letter of Agreement.

1.2. Distribution

All operationally significant information and procedures contained in this Letter of Agreement shall be distributed by the appropriate means to all concerned controllers.

1.3. Validity

This Letter of Agreement becomes effective 26/01/2026 and supersedes the Letter of Agreement between Helsinki FIR and Sweden FIR dated 17/04/2025.

Martin Loxbo Director Sweden FIR	Mika Hellgren Director of Helsinki FIR

2. Areas of Responsibility and Sectorization

2.1. Areas of Responsibility

2.1.1. Helsinki FIR

Lateral limits:	Helsinki FIR
Vertical limits:	SFC – UNL

2.1.2. Sweden FIR

Lateral limits:	Sweden FIR
Vertical limits:	North of 593346N:
	- Stockholm AoR (ESOS): SFC – UNL
	South of 593346N:
	- Malmö AoR (ESMM): FL285 – UNL
	- Stockholm AoR (ESOS): SFC – FL285

2.2. Sectorization

A sectorization map is shown in Appendix 1.

For detailed coordinates and sector ownership, refer to GNG, AIP Finland, or AIP Sweden. Any changes affecting the sectors listed in 2.2.1 and 2.2.2 shall be notified at least one week prior to the implementation of the changes.

2.2.1. Helsinki FIR

Sector	Ownership
J	EFIN_J_CTR 126.100 EFIN_H_CTR 124.200 EFIN_V_CTR 126.300 EFIN_M_CTR 132.325 EFIN_G_CTR 127.100 EFIN_F_CTR 132.725 EFIN_D_CTR 131.200
H	EFIN_H_CTR 124.200 EFIN_V_CTR 126.300 EFIN_M_CTR 132.325 EFIN_G_CTR 127.100 EFIN_F_CTR 132.725 EFIN_D_CTR 121.300
V	EFIN_V_CTR 126.300 EFIN_M_CTR 132.325 EFIN_G_CTR 127.100 EFIN_F_CTR 132.725 EFIN_D_CTR 121.300 EFIN_C_CTR 132.675
G	EFIN_G_CTR 127.100 EFIN_F_CTR 132.725 EFIN_D_CTR 121.300 EFIN_C_CTR 132.675
F	EFIN_F_CTR 132.725 EFIN_D_CTR 121.300 EFIN_C_CTR 132.675
D	EFIN_D_CTR 121.300 EFIN_C_CTR 132.675
C	EFIN_C_CTR 132.675 EFIN_D_CTR 121.300
B	EFIN_B_CTR 125.225 EFIN_C_CTR 132.675 EFIN_D_CTR 121.300

Note: Callsign for all EFIN sectors is HELSINKI CONTROL.

2.2.2. Sweden FIR

ATCC	Sector	Logon	Frequency
Stockholm	K	ESOS_K_CTR	131.055
	F	ESOS_F_CTR	124.430
	4	ESOS_4_CTR	118.205
	6	ESOS_6_CTR	132.480
Malmö	Y	ESMM_Y_CTR	134.455

Note: Callsign for all ESMM and ESOS sectors is SWEDEN CONTROL.

3. Delegated Airspace

3.1. Airspace delegated from Helsinki FIR to Sweden FIR

3.1.1. Delegation of ATS from Helsinki ACC to Stockholm ACC

3.1.1.1. Area KVARKEN

Lateral limits:	633045N 0205302E – 613714N 0192914E – FIR boundary – 633045N 0205302E.
Vertical limits:	FL95 – FL660
Airspace classification:	C

In the event that Helsinki ACC is temporarily cancelling the delegation of ATS in area KVARKEN, a 15-minute prior notice shall be given to Stockholm ACC.

KVARKEN CTA is shown on the sectorization map in Appendix 1.

3.2. Airspace delegated from Sweden FIR to Helsinki FIR

Not applicable.

3.3. Special Areas

3.3.1. Delegation of ATS from Helsinki ACC to Polaris ACC Bodø

3.3.1.1. Area HALTI

Lateral limits:	The portion of Helsinki FIR west of a parallel line 6 NM east of line between GAPRO and OGLAV.
Vertical limits:	FL95 – FL660
Airspace classification:	C
Coordination:	All messages concerning traffic in area HALTI will be exchanged between ESOS and ENBD. ENBD is responsible for coordination with EFIN.

4. Procedures for Coordination

4.1. ATS Routes and Flight Level Allocation

Standard flight level allocation is to be used on all routes.

*Note: Standard flight level allocation (in RVSM airspace) means that aircraft on eastbound routes (magnetic track 360°-179°) are to use **odd** flight levels and westbound flights (magnetic track 180°-359°) are to use **even** flight levels.*

4.2. Special Procedures

4.2.1. Flights from Sweden FIR to Helsinki FIR

4.2.1.1. Flights from Stockholm ACC to Helsinki ACC

Route	Rule
Destination EFET, EFKT or EFRO	ESOS gives descent clearance to FL100. The traffic is considered descending to FL100.
Destination EFKE	ESOS gives descent clearance to FL100. The traffic is considered descending to FL100. Traffic with destination EFKE, or flying through EFKE TMA at or below FL95, shall be transferred to EFKE_TWR 119.400 unless otherwise coordinated.
ESNU – EFVA	Flights between ESNU TMA and EFVA TMA at or below FL95 shall be transferred to EFVA_APP 125.850 (secondary frequency EFVA_TWR 120.950) unless otherwise coordinated.
Destination EFMA	Traffic inbound EFMA shall be routed via RIKUM or DODAM. ESOS gives descent clearance to FL100. The traffic is considered descending to FL100. Traffic with destination EFMA, or flying through EFMA TMA at or below FL95, shall be transferred to EFMA TWR/APP 119.600 unless otherwise coordinated.
COP UXETI	Traffic filed via UXETI may be rerouted direct UXETI without coordination. Traffic must enter EFIN FIR south of KELAS.

Route	Rule
Departure Stockholm TMA	Departing traffic from Stockholm TMA shall be considered climbing to the coordinated flight level. Traffic via COPs DODAM and RIKUM will be cleared by ESOS to FL290 or requested flight level if lower.

4.2.1.2. Flights from Malmö ACC to Helsinki ACC

Route	Rule
Departure Stockholm TMA	Departing traffic from Stockholm TMA shall be considered climbing to the coordinated flight level.

4.2.2. Flights from Helsinki FIR to Sweden FIR

4.2.2.1. Flights from Helsinki ACC to Stockholm ACC

Route	Rule
Departure EFET	Traffic is coordinated with ESOS before departure. EFIN gives climb clearance to FL300, or requested flight level if lower. The traffic shall be considered climbing to the coordinated flight level.
Departure EFKT or EFRO	EFIN gives climb clearance to FL300, or requested flight level if lower. The traffic shall be considered climbing to the coordinated flight level.
Departure EFVA	Flights departing EFVA between LAMPI and BAKLA shall be considered climbing when passing the transfer of control point.
EFVA – ESNU	Flights between EFVA TMA and ESNU TMA at or below FL95 shall be transferred to ESNU_TWR 119.805 *(see Note 2)* unless otherwise coordinated.
KVARKEN	EFIN may give direct clearances to points on the boundary of ESAA and EFIN FIRs in KVARKEN area.
COP RUNGA or LUPET	Traffic via RUNGA and LUPET are to be regarded as one flow of traffic and shall be considered climbing to or maintaining the coordinated flight level. Traffic filed via XILAN may be rerouted DCT XILAN without coordination. Traffic must enter ESAA FIR south of RUNGA.

Route	Rule
Destination Stockholm TMA *(see Note 1)*	Flights via COPs between LUPET and KELAS with destination inside Stockholm TMA and cruising level above FL200 will by EFIN be given descent clearance to FL200. The traffic is considered descending to FL200. Traffic departing EFMA and with destination inside Stockholm TMA may be cleared direct XILAN.

Note 1: Aerodromes inside Stockholm TMA are ESSA, ESSB, ESCM, ESOW and ESSU.

Note 2: A special position named ESSR_CTR exists. When online, it covers regional airports in Sweden where no local APP/TWR is online. Callsign and frequency to be used when transferring aircraft to ESSR_CTR are the local ATC callsign and frequency unless otherwise coordinated.

4.2.2.2. Flights from Helsinki ACC to Malmö ACC

Route	Rule
Departure EFHK, EFTP or EFTU	Departing traffic from EFHK, EFTP and EFTU shall be considered climbing to the coordinated flight level. If the traffic cannot pass 2.5NM before the AoR boundary at or above FL290, Helsinki ACC is responsible for coordination with Stockholm ACC.

4.3. Tactical re-routing

Tactical re-routing shall be managed within the AoR of the relevant ATC unit whenever practicable. If rejoining the FPL route within the AoR is deemed impracticable, the flight may be cleared direct (DCT) to the next waypoint on the FPL route without prior coordination, provided the estimated updated flying time to the AoR boundary is 15 minutes or more.

4.4. VFR Flights

Controlled VFR flights are subject to prior coordination.

5. Transfer of Control and Transfer of Communications

Note: A "release" is an authorization for the accepting unit to climb, descend or turn (by not more than 45°) a specific aircraft before the transfer of control.

5.1. Transfer of Control

Transfer of control takes place at the AoR boundary.

A release may be affected before the AoR boundary with the TRANSFER function.

After the TRANSFER function, traffic at or above FL100 is fully released including speed adjustments with regard to third party and traffic for which co-ordination data has been exchanged. The traffic shall not be cleared below FL100 before crossing the AoR boundary without prior coordination, unless otherwise described below.

After the TRANSFER function, traffic below FL100 is not released unless otherwise described in 5.1.1.

5.1.1. EFMA

After the TRANSFER function the traffic departing from EFMA is fully released.

After the TRANSFER function the traffic with destination EFMA is fully released within Stockholm TMA. The traffic may not be cleared below FL70 without prior coordination.

5.2. Transfer of Communications

Transfer of communications shall take place not later than the transfer of control.

The transferring ATS unit shall make an approval request to the receiving ATS unit about which frequency to be used before the transfer of communications for aircraft that are not equipped with 8.33 kHz spacing capability.

Note: Helsinki ACC is until further notice exempted from the requirement of 8.33 kHz spacing capability frequencies and accept aircraft not equipped with 8.33 kHz radio on normal VHF-frequencies without prior coordination.

6. Radar Based Coordination Procedures

6.1. SSR Code Assignment

Both ATS units shall transfer aircraft on verified discrete SSR codes. Any change of SSR code by the accepting ATS unit may only take place after the transfer of control point.

6.2. Vectoring

Radar vectoring may take place without coordination between the units, provided the distance to the AoR boundary is never less than 2.5 NM.

6.3. Radar Coordination Procedures

6.3.1. Transfer of Radar Control

Transfer of radar control may be effected after prior verbal coordination or by using the ROF function provided the minimum distance between the aircraft does not fall below **5 NM**.

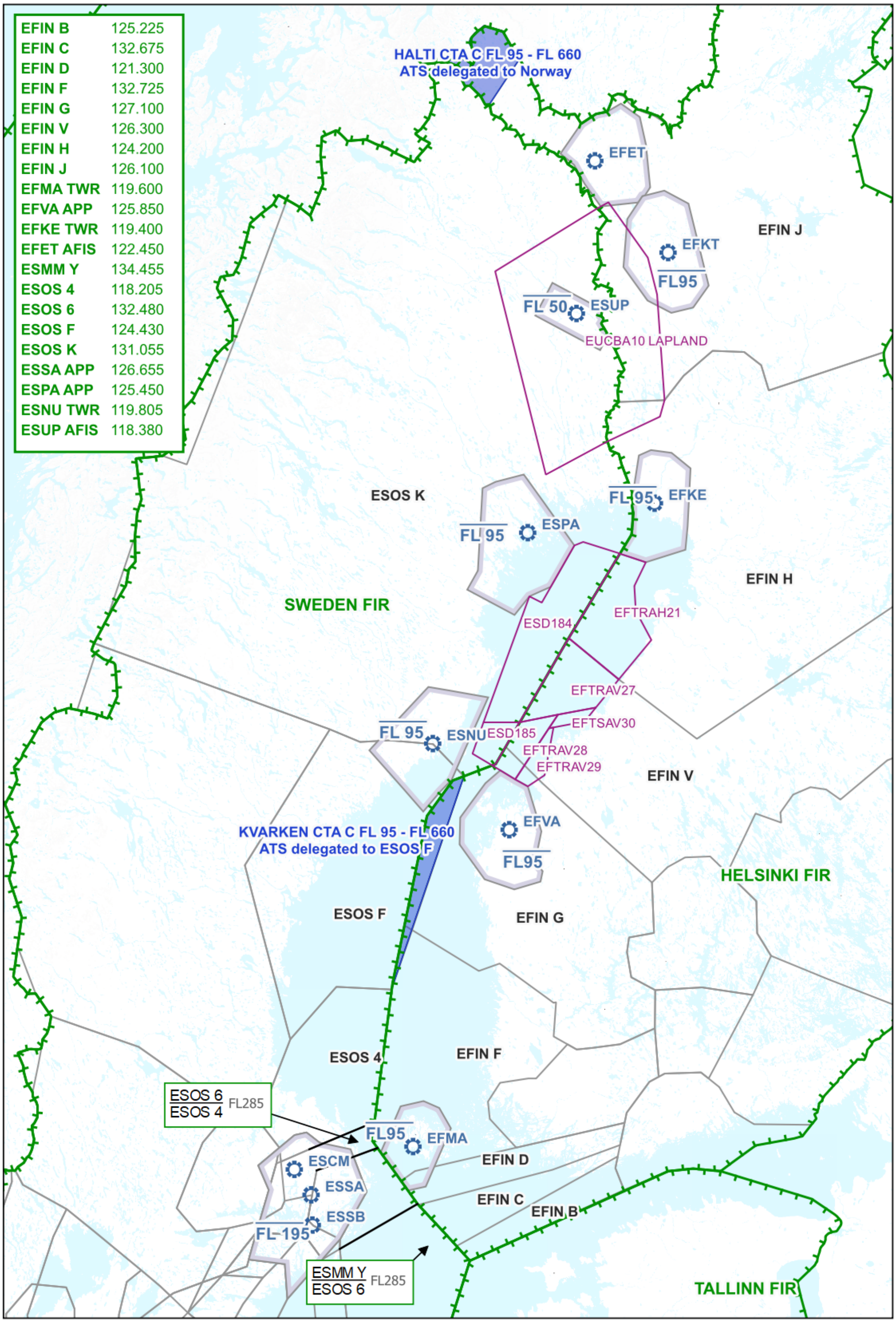
Note: When using speed control, the assigned speed will be transferred via ASP in the label.

6.3.2. Silent Transfer of Radar Control

Transfer of radar control may be effected without prior verbal coordination provided the minimum distance between successive aircraft about to be transferred is **10 NM** and constant or increasing.

Note: When using speed control, the assigned speed will be transferred via ASP in the label.

Appendix 1 - Sectorization map



Appendix 2 – Changelog

Date	Changes
26.01.2026	- Clarified the use of TRANSFER function in para 5.1 and 5.1.1. - Introduction of Appendix 2 – Changelog